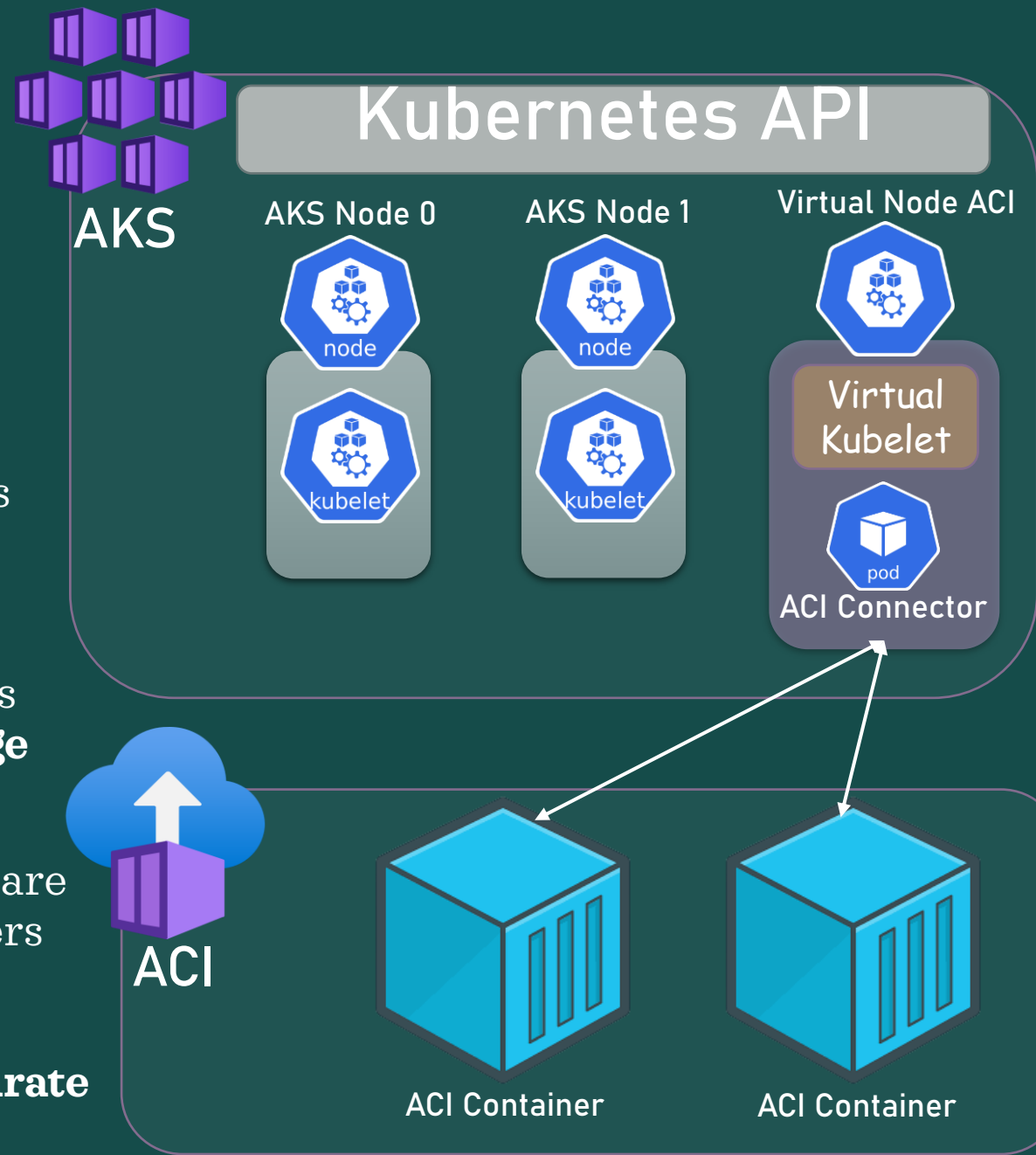


Virtual node add-on for AKS

- A **virtual node** in AKS allows running Kubernetes **pods** on **Azure Container Instances (ACI)** instead of traditional worker nodes
- **Virtual Node = ACI + Virtual Kubelet**
 - **ACI is a serverless** service that enables the deployment of containers on Azure **without managing virtual machines or infrastructure**
 - **Virtual Kubelet** implements the Kubernetes Container Runtime Interface (CRI) and Kubernetes Node API to function as a **"fake" node** within the Kubernetes cluster
- When **the virtual node add-on is enabled**, a **new pod** is added in kube-system namespace that works as a **bridge between the AKS cluster and ACI management API**
- **Containers running on ACI** with virtual node support are **charged** based on the **amount of time** that the containers are **running**
- **Virtual node** functionality **requires running in a separate subnet** than AKS's subnet



Virtual nodes add-on for AKS

- **Limitations**
 - Using API server authorized IP ranges
 - Supports only the Azure CNI networking plugin, not kubenet
 - Do not support init containers
 - DaemonSets will not deploy pods on the virtual node
 - Others